

YOUR SHOP.



1
ONCE

WHERE WE SHOP

Main shop

Branch, or delivery

Shopping day Slot or time

Loyalty card, and the account

Budget a week A month

Write your aisle order once, and the rest of this kit follows it

Walk your shop in your head from the door to the till and number what you pass. Every list in here is then written in **that** order rather than in categories invented by somebody who has never been to your shop — which is the whole reason for walking back across the place for the thing you forgot.

THE AISLE ORDER, OURS Door to till

- 1

2
- 3

4
- 5

6
- 7

8
- 9

10
- 11

12

THE OTHER PLACES

SHOP	WHAT WE GET THERE	OFTEN
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.....		
.....		
.....		
.....		

BOUGHT EVERY SINGLE TIME The standing list

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

WHAT WE ALWAYS RUN OUT OF

.....

.....

.....

.....

WHO GOES

Usually

If nobody can

THE THREE RULES OF THIS SHOP Ours

.....

.....

.....

THE KITCHEN CHECK.

Week of _____



Stand in front of the fridge with this page

Almost everything bought twice is bought because nobody looked. Five minutes here, with the fridge open and the cupboard door open, is the difference between a list and a guess — and it is also where the week’s cooking decides itself, because what has to be used up comes first.

USE FIRST Going over in the next three days

WHAT	BY WHEN	USED
_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	☐

FRIDGE — LOW OR GONE

FREEZER — WHAT IS ACTUALLY IN THERE

CUPBOARD — LOW OR GONE Page 8 has the levels

HOUSEHOLD, CLEANING, PAPER

TOILETRIES, AND THE MEDICINE CABINET

PET, BABY, ANYTHING ELSE

ALREADY HAVE TOO MUCH OF Do not buy these again this week

THE WEEK'S FOOD.

Week of _____



3
WEEKLY

DINNERS F from the freezer · S needs shopping

DAY	WHAT WE ARE EATING	AT TABLE	F	S
Mon	_____	_____	☐	☐
Tue	_____	_____	☐	☐
Wed	_____	_____	☐	☐
Thu	_____	_____	☐	☐
Fri	_____	_____	☐	☐
Sat	_____	_____	☐	☐
Sun	_____	_____	☐	☐

THE TWO NIGHTS NOBODY COOKS Name them now

NIGHT	WHAT HAPPENS INSTEAD
_____	_____
_____	_____

BREAKFASTS AND LUNCHES TO COVER

Plan two fewer meals than you think

Seven dinners get planned, four get cooked, and the other three turn up on page 7 as a bag of salad and a packet of chicken thighs. Plan five, write the freezer night and the nobody-cooks night down as real plans rather than failures, and the waste log stops filling up.

COOKS FROM WHAT IS ALREADY HERE

NEEDS BUYING These go onto page 4

COOKS TWICE Make the double batch on purpose

WHO IS OUT THIS WEEK

THE LIST, IN AISLE ORDER.

Week of _____



4
WEEKLY

AISLE, FROM PAGE 1

QTY

IN

1 _____

_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	☐

2 _____

_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	☐

3 _____

_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	☐

AISLE, FROM PAGE 1

QTY

IN

4 _____

_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	☐

5 _____

_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	☐

6 _____

_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	☐



THE BIG SHOP, AND THE TOP-UP.

Week of _____

THE BIG SHOP Heavy, bulky, keeps — not fresh

WHAT	SIZE	QTY	IN
------	------	-----	----

_____	_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	_____	☐

Cleaning, paper, tins, rice and pasta, drinks, pet food, washing powder.
None of it needs to be bought fresh and all of it is heavy, so it belongs in one trip a month rather than in the weekly basket where it quietly doubles the bill.

WHERE THE BIG SHOP GOES

Shop, and when _____

NEVER WORTH BUYING BIG Goes off, or nobody likes it that much

The top-up is where the money actually goes

Three quick trips a week for bread and milk cost more than most households' meat budget, because nobody walks out of a shop with only bread and milk. If there is going to be a top-up, write it here first — and if the list is two items long, send whoever can go in and out without a basket.

THE TOP-UP Bread, milk, fruit, salad

WHAT	IN
------	----

_____	☐
_____	☐
_____	☐
_____	☐
_____	☐
_____	☐
_____	☐

NEVER ORDERED ONLINE The things we want to choose ourselves

SUBSTITUTIONS WE WILL ACCEPT And the ones we will not

WHAT IT COSTS.

Week of _____



6
MONTHLY

THIS MONTH'S SHOPS Every one of them, including the top-ups

DATE	WHERE	SPENT	PLAN
_____	_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	_____	☐

BUDGET _____ SPENT _____ LEFT _____

The line that matters is not the big shop, it is the number of rows. Four shops a month and a full trolley beats eleven shops and a basket, every time.

Compare per 100 g, not per packet

The shelf label carries a unit price in small print, and it is the only number on the shelf that tells the truth. The big box is often dearer per gram than the middle one, the offer is sometimes dearer than the plain shelf price, and the loose vegetables are almost always cheaper than the same vegetables in a bag.

WORKED OUT ONCE Per 100 g, per litre, per wash

WHAT	SIZE	PRICE	PER UNIT
_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____

ALWAYS OWN-BRAND Tested, no difference

NEVER OWN-BRAND For us, worth the money

ONLY WHEN IT IS ON OFFER

Week of



7
MONTHLY

THE LOG

Date, what, and why — one line

DATE _____

WHAT

WHY IT WAS NOT EATEN

The bin is the cheapest place to look for money

Nothing on this page was bought carelessly. It was bought by somebody planning to eat well: the salad, the herbs, the yoghurts, the second bag of spinach. Keeping this page for one month changes what goes in the trolley more than any budget does, because you stop arguing with yourself about what you *should* eat and start buying what you actually ate.

SHOWS UP MORE THAN TWICE

BUY LESS OF

BUY SMALLER, OR LOOSE

FREEZE IT INSTEAD

On the day it comes in

WHAT WE ARE DOING DIFFERENTLY

The four honest reasons: bought too much, never got round to it, went off sooner than expected, nobody actually likes it. Write the real one.

Week of



A shopping list is an inventory problem

You do not need to remember to buy rice. You need to know the number below which rice goes on the list — and then anybody in the house can write the list, not just the person who holds it all in their head. Fill this in once, in front of the open cupboard, and page 2 becomes a two-minute job.

STAPLES Full • re-order at • have now

THE FREEZER Dated going in, or it is an archaeology dig

FREEZER RULES WE KEEP

- ☐ Everything is dated and named on the day it goes in
- ☐ Flat bags, standing up, not a pile
- ☐ One shelf or drawer is the eat-me-next shelf
- ☐ Leftovers get frozen the same evening, not on day three

WHERE THINGS LIVE No fourth jar

WHAT	WHERE IT IS KEPT	SEEN

WHAT WE FORGOT.

Week of _____



THE FORGOT LIST Tick it when it reaches page 1

DATE	WHAT WE FORGOT	ON P1
_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	☐

It is the same three or four things forever. Once a thing has been written here twice it belongs on the standing list on page 1, and then it stops being something anybody has to remember.

WHAT IS GOOD WHERE Worth the separate trip

SHOP	WHAT	PRICE
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____

NOT WORTH IT HERE

TRY NEXT TIME

PRICES WORTH REMEMBERING Know a real offer

NOTES
